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Top Skills

Enterprise Network
AI Prompting
Metadata

Languages

English (Full Professional)
French (Limited Working)

Certifications

LinkedIn's AI Academy
DEI Actions for Individual Contributors
Unlocking Authentic Communication in a Culturally-Diverse Workplace
Learn API Documentation with JSON and XML
Change Management for Projects

Publications

Collisionville: A Bay Area Band with Alabama Roots Confronts the Ghost of Hank Williams

Joseph Hughes

AI-first Knowledge Leader @ LinkedIn | Technical Communication | Knowledge Management | UX
Albany, California, United States

Summary

I design the content systems that help AI products work the way people expect them to. My focus is on structure, clarity, and the underlying frameworks like taxonomies, metadata, and content models that make information findable for both humans and large language models.At LinkedIn, I worked across Recruiter and Career products to build the knowledge structures behind AI-Assisted Search, AI-Assisted Messaging, Hiring Assistant, and other model-driven experiences. That means partnering closely with engineering, product, and research to shape content pipelines, improve retrieval quality, and make sure the right information surfaces at the right moment.I work in docs-as-code environments (Git, CI/CD, Markdown, JSON/YAML) and use Python to automate the repetitive parts of content operations. My goal is always the same: create content systems that are clean, scalable, and easy for humans and AI to use.The industry has shifted quickly, and I've shifted with it. What matters now is fluency with AI tooling, comfort with technical workflows, and the ability to build content that models can actually use. That's the space where I do my best work.

Experience

LinkedIn
7 years 4 months

Senior Content Strategist
November 2021 - Present (4 years 8 months)
San Francisco Bay Area

· Led AI-ready content strategy for knowledge systems powering virtual chat, in-product help, and self-service experiences, improving product adoption and retrieval

· Owned content strategy for Search, Messaging, and Hiring Assistant experiences, with a strong focus on AI-assisted workflows and user guidance for emerging AI features

· Built help-center content optimized for semantic search, AI retrieval, and faster task completion across high-intent user journeys
· Strengthened metadata quality, taxonomy, and classification logic on the KMS Taxonomy Governance team to improve relevance, discoverability, and retrieval performance
· Scaled documentation workflows across KMS, Customer Education, and Customer Learning to support higher-volume AI-era content operations with greater consistency and speed
· Ran release documentation across product roadmaps and launches, helping teams ship AI-assisted and product-led experiences with less content debt
· Championed inclusive language and equitable content practices through DIBs leadership, reinforcing responsible and user-centered content design
· Wrote product documentation, release notes, and in-product guidance tailored to diverse intents, audiences, and AI-supported user scenarios
· Used analytics to improve information architecture, discoverability, and team productivity, helping create stronger foundations for AI readiness

Technical Writer
March 2019 - November 2021 (2 years 9 months)
San Francisco, CA

• Produced clear, scalable documentation for LinkedIn's Learning's Enterprise products, including user guides, release notes, and in-product help
• Collaborated with product managers, engineers, and UX partners to translate complex technical concepts into intuitive, user-centered content
• Supported early AI-driven features by structuring content for improved discoverability and semantic search
• Maintained documentation quality through consistent terminology, editorial standards, and cross-functional review cycles
• Delivered multiple projects on time while managing competing priorities across product teams

Acuity Brands
Technical Writer
January 2018 - May 2018 (5 months)
Berkeley, CA

• Wrote external customer-facing procedures and processes (in MadCap Flare) for a cloud-based Internet of Things (IoT) platform
• Liaise with developers and engineers on critical technical support-driven content
• Redesign and manage the documentation site using HTML5, CSS, and XML

BBVA Compass (Applications Delivery)

Lead Technical Writer

September 2015 - April 2017 (1 year 8 months)

Greater Birmingham, Alabama Area

• Worked closely with developers to improve employee and customer experience during a large
multichannel product transformation

• Enhanced search efficiencies in the Change Management SharePoint and Salesforce
knowledge bases

• Re-wrote documents per the DITA standard (using FrameMaker XML Author and oXygen)
across multiple channels to create a unified company voice

• Reduced call center volume by producing a customer-facing enterprise bill payment user guide and HTML help files

• Put the bank in compliance with federal regulations by producing a cybersecurity/PCI manual

• Maintained the Change Management web page and document libraries

NOAA: National Oceanic & Atmospheric Administration

Technical Writer

January 2015 - July 2015 (7 months)

The National Water Center, University of Alabama, Tuscaloosa, AL

• Communicated foundational standards for the National Water Center by producing user manuals, release notes, and articles on technology- and subject matter (water resourcing, weather, climate)-related topics

• Standardized cybersecurity guidelines per the National Institute of Standards & Technology (NIST) protocols

• Liaised with SMEs in driving technology implementation and improvement initiatives (business requirements, workflows, legal and compliance)

BBVA Compass

Technical Writer

September 2010 - September 2014 (4 years 1 month)

Birmingham, Alabama Area

• Managed Change Management documentation workflow in a global banking software migration
(from green screens to an integrated web-based platform)

• Developed use cases, process design (Visio diagrams), and tutorials for developers and
internal customers
• Wrote, edited, and curated the following materials for global software upgrade:
• User manuals for developers and external customers (five manuals, 200 to 500 pages)
• In-context UI instructions
• APIs, including REST
• Reference guides (two guides, 150 to 200 pages)
• HTML help files (over 400)
• Software simulations (six Captivate videos)
• Liaised with product managers, developers, and engineers regarding their training needs
• Matched high-level technical specifications with business requirements

MasterCard
Educational Content Writer
September 2001 - June 2010 (8 years 10 months)
Remote

• Storyboarded and scripted courses based on ADDIE and Interactive Multimedia Instruction (IMI) principles for the MasterCard online training program
• Liaised with developers to produce media and Flash-based interactive exercises
• Developed descriptive material, case studies, and test questions
• Tracked user progress in the learning management system (Moodle)

Palm Inc., The Oak Hill Corporation
Technical Editor
2009 - 2009 (less than a year)
Remote

• Edited technical documentation for Palm Pre smart phone and its webOS platform
• Matched technical specifications with user requirements
• Liaised between subject matter experts and project managers
• Converted Framemaker files to PDFs using Adobe Acrobat

The ROI Institute
Editor
January 2008 - September 2008 (9 months)

Birmingham, AL

• Edited manuscripts for publication
• Set and met deadlines
• Liaised between authors and publishers
• Formatted manuscripts to publisher guidelines
• Coordinated foreign rights agreements with international publishers
• Coordinated print production management for self-published books and their marketing materials

F5 Networks
Technical Writer
August 1999 - July 2000 (1 year)
Seattle, WA

• Wrote and edited technical documentation for an Ask Jeeves interface project
• Co-wrote and edited user's manual for BIG-IP Internet network router
• Edited database customer support material and worked with product development team to formulate new procedures
• Reformatted FrameMaker documents and converted them into Web pages
• Organized keywords and grouped material for search engine optimization (SEO)
• Evaluated end-user business needs and communicated them to the Product Development team

Microsoft Corporation
Editor
January 1999 - December 1999 (1 year)
Redmond, WA

• Revised, edited, and researched articles on information technology and scientific topics for Microsoft's Encarta Deluxe 2000 and 2001 editions
• Liaised between academic contributors and the Senior and Managing Editor
• Selected and formatted media, sidebars, and graphical interfaces to complement article texts

Education

Columbia University in the City of New York
Bachelor's Degree, English Literature